FMEA quick reference

IES | Primer 3.0 | Synthetic worked example

FMEA examines how a function can fail and the effect of that failure. Use it to organise prospective failure analysis before decisions are made.

Read a row

Function: deliver controlled dose. Failure mode: no flow. Effect: underdose. Cause: pump failure hypothesis. Current control: weekly check.

Worked RPN

Classroom S=8, O=4, D=6. RPN=8 x 4 x 6=192. Another row with S=9, O=3, D=7 gives 189 and still needs high-severity review.

Scale direction

Severity is consequence; occurrence is frequency judgement; detection is how poorly the effect is detected. Higher D means poorer detection. Use the supplied classroom scale, not invented precision.

Action and review

Separate existing controls from proposed actions. Record owner, due date and effectiveness evidence. Do not lower residual ratings simply because an action was proposed.